

positions for candidates with specific cloud skills and positions for candidates who are experienced in handling and designing cloud architecture.

Specific cloud computing skills are associated with companies working with a single cloud service provider i.e. either one from AWS, Google Cloud Computing, Rackspace and so on. You are expected to be comfortable working with the tools and services made available by these providers. The market is currently flooded with jobs in these category – companies which have or in the process of shifting their software or infrastructure to the cloud look for people with such skill sets. The requirement for IT pros with advanced skills in deploying and managing resources on AWS exceeds by a large margin, the requirement for Google, Microsoft and Rackspace skill.

Similarly, for cloud architects, companies seek candidates who can control and manage every aspect of cloud from defining the business requirements to its actual deployment.

Usually companies who do not have a clear roadmap on how they plan to implement their cloud policies and need assistance in doing so require such candidates. They're expected to work with either public, existing private cloud or may be asked to setup a cloud solution from scratch. These candidates are required to have more of a long-term strategic skill set while the jobs discussed earlier need people with tactical skills which will help solve operational problems.

The IDC report that we discussed earlier also states that a lot of these jobs are going unfilled primarily due to lack of training, certification and experience. These are vendor specific certifications so they tend to focus and lay importance on their own offerings but they do offer a general background on various cloud computing basics and architecture. These certification tend to limit your knowledge to a specific provider only on top of that these courses

Cloud Certifications

The number of cloud certification programs are also increasing with the increase in job positions. Large technology providers such as Microsoft, IBM, and Google and some other independent training organizations are currently offering such programs. Some of the better cloud certification programs are:

- AWS Certification Program http://goo.gl/FiYDy - Cloud U Professional - Rackspace http://goo.gl/r05wv - Google Apps Certified Deployment Specialist http://goo.gl/xHV9E - Microsoft Learning http://goo.gl/9KaJ1 - IBM Certified Solution Advisor – Cloud Computing Architecture	http://goo.gl/RXh1J - IBM Certified Solution Architect – Cloud Computing Infrastructure http://goo.gl/koQEQ - VMware Certified Professional (VCP) http://goo.gl/H7Boi - Certified Cloud Professional (CCP) http://goo.gl/1puMJ
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tend to skim over the surface with just basics of IaaS, PaaS and SaaS and so on; they don't delve down into the gory details of the many problems and challenges that companies face when shifting to a cloud based service. Currently a majority of the professionals working at specific cloud positions and architect-level positions are self taught or have a large experience to draw skills from. With the number of positions for such skills increasing companies will start looking for people with certifications and training. This surely make sure that in the future, the curriculums of these courses become more comprehensive and more and more colleges start teaching the basics of such systems in the classrooms itself.

Conclusion

There is fear among IT personnel across the industry that shifting core infrastructure to the cloud will make their jobs obsolete. Although that is not entirely true, it is just the question of moving up in the model, from IaaS to PaaS and SaaS, as cloud deployment opens its own can of worms like the challenges in virtualization automation, multi-tenant architecture, identity-based security and API design to name a few. Their jobs will not become obsolete only the focus in their jobs will change. Responsibilities will move from designing to deploying. All in all investing your time and resources as an IT professional in cloud computing with the current pace of growth seems to be safe bet and a wise career decision.